

COURTESY CALL KCR with PM Modi

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Q. Why didn't you entrust power projects to private players?
As a policy, we have stayed with the public sector, because it is in my control. There is so much competition among states for investments. This gives me an advantage, as I can offer cheaper power rates to companies coming to Telangana. It is subsidy to some extent in the beginning, but after some time, it becomes earning.

Q. How did you grow private industry in the new state?
I took the advice of experts like Pradeep Chandra, a former chief secretary, and with their help studied industrial policies not only of Indian states but across the globe. We formulated a wonderful scheme called TS-iPass (Telangana State Industrial Project Approval and Self-Certification Scheme), which really paid dividends. In this scheme, which we made into a law, everything is online; our government only has to check whether the investor is genuine or not. Within 15 days, investors get all the necessary sanctions like power, water, land—some 57 clearances in all—to set up industry. If the government doesn't respond in 15 days, by the 16th day, it is deemed to have sanction.

Q. What has been the outcome?
Cumulatively, TS-iPASS has so far attracted 22,745 industries, investments of Rs 2.6 lakh crore and created 1.7 million jobs. We have grown in all the key sectors—IT, biotech and others. In IT, our exports were around Rs 57,000 crore in 2013-14. Now, they are around Rs 3 lakh crore. Our goal is to become an IT hub and overtake Bengaluru.

> **"PM MODI ACCUSES US OF *PARIVARVAAD*. HE IS A LIAR. THE BJP GIVES TICKETS TO *PARIVARS*. YEDIYURAPPA'S SON WAS MADE KARNATAKA BJP CHIEF. WHERE WAS *PARIVARVAAD* THEN, MR MODI?"**

Q. How have you managed the fiscal deficit?
Telangana's debt is lower than 25 per cent of its GSDP. I am not a bankrupt state. Deficit is part of budget-making. Borrowing is. Who is the biggest loanee in the world? America and Japan. Banks stand in queue to buy Telangana's bonds.

Q. What was your focus in the second term?
It was a continuation of the efforts of the first term. Since there was no disturbance, there was political stability, we were able to deliver the goods. We focused on both industry and irrigation projects. In irrigation, we increased the speed of implementation. We have a difficult geographical situation as the riverbed levels of two major rivers—Krishna and Godavari—are lower and water has to be lifted by over 500 metres to supply to other regions. We had no way but to employ lift irrigation even though it is expensive.

Q. Opposition parties allege that the piers of the Medigadda barrage of the Kaleshwaram Lift Irrigation Scheme collapsed recently because of poor oversight and corruption.
Kaleshwaram is the world's largest multi-stage irrigation scheme. There are hundreds of pillars and only one collapsed. I still suspect there is some conspiracy and have lodged a police complaint. The construction was done by L&T and whatever went wrong, they will rectify at their cost—so, there is no loss to the exchequer. It is silly of the Congress to allege that KCR took Rs 1 lakh crore when the cost of the entire project is only Rs 80,000 crore.

Q. You are accused of promoting dynastic politics with your son, daughter, nephew and other relatives part of the government.
The fact is, my entire family was involved in the Telangana agitation. Both my son and daughter fought for it in a very big way. They were educated